

2024 JavaScript Rising Stars: The Year's Hottest Projects by GitHub Stars

9th edition of JavaScript Rising Stars

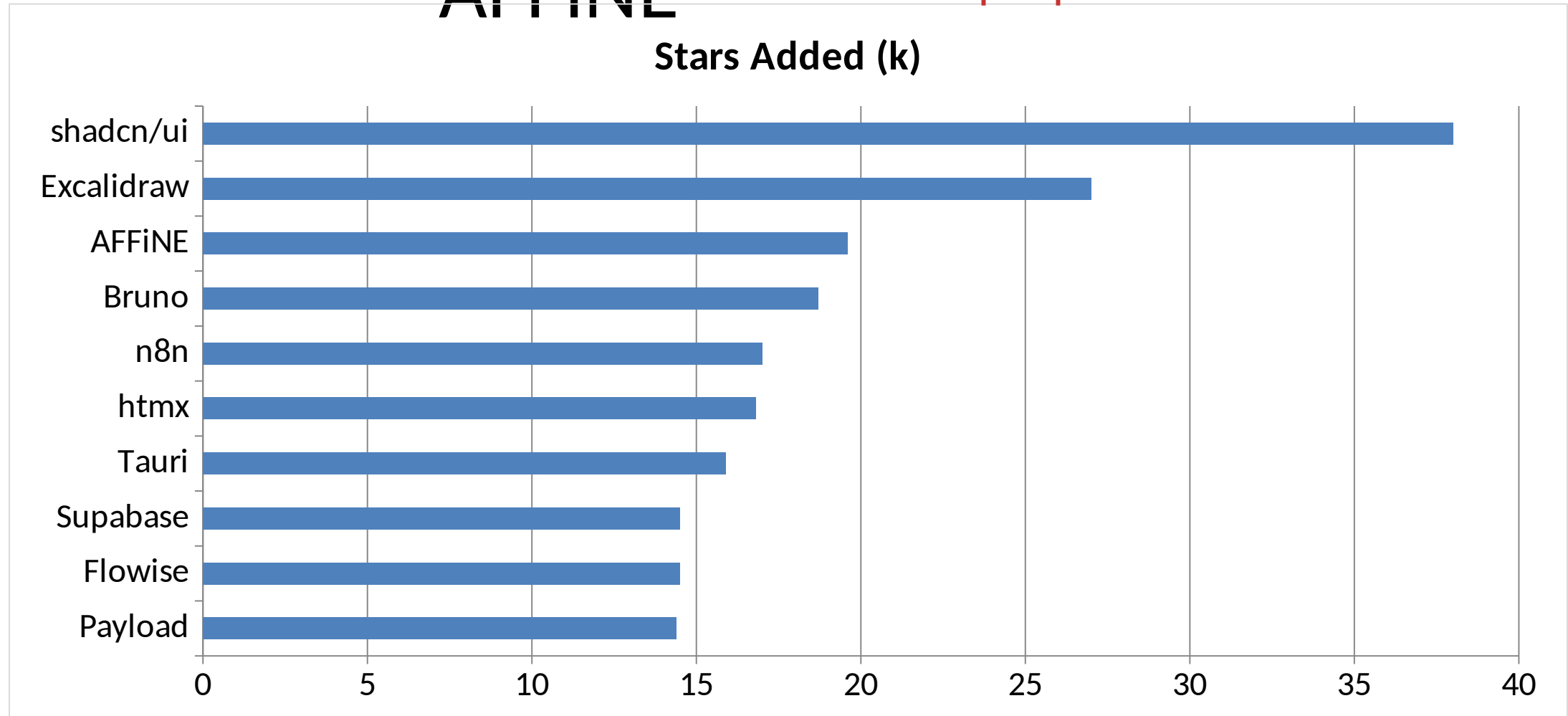
Methodology: GitHub stars added in
2024 from Best of JS curated list

Target Audience: Frontend engineers
& engineering managers

shadcn/ui Leads Overall with +38k Stars, Followed by Excalidraw and

AFFiNE

Gap Emphasized: shadcn/ui has a +11k lead over #2



shadcn/ui: Copy-Paste Components Win for the Second Consecutive Year

Year-over-Year Trajectory:

- 2016-2022: N/A
- 2023: +39.5k stars
- 2024: +38.0k stars (77.5k total)

Key 2024 Additions:

- Charts (powered by Recharts)
- Themes (CSS variable generation)
- Blocks (layout collections) & Sidebar
- Upgraded CLI with multi-framework support

Ecosystem Growth:

- Spawns derivative libraries like Motion-Primitives
 - Integration with Vercel's v0 for AI components

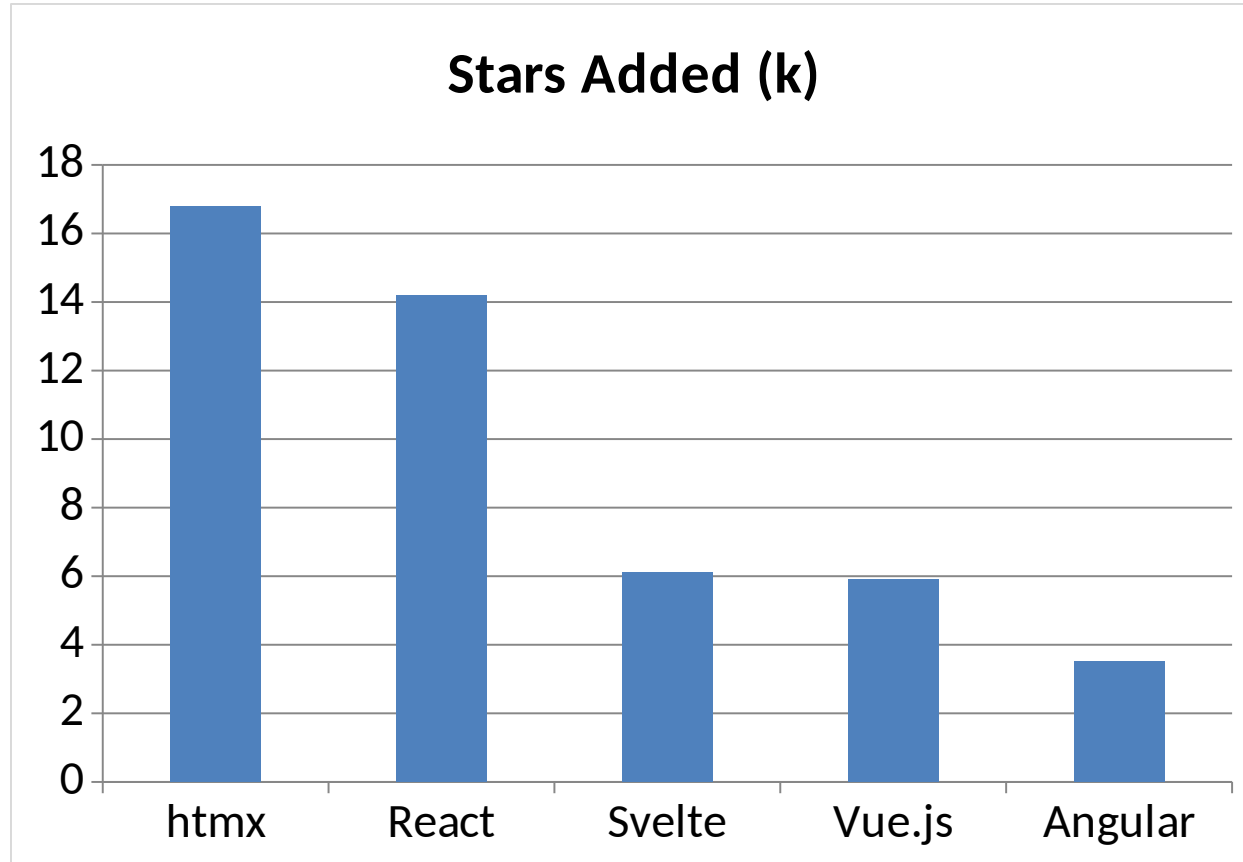
By year

39.5k

Trends in 2024

7.3k

htmx Overtakes React as #1 Front-end Framework by Stars Added



htmx (+16.8k):

- Extends HTML with hx-* attributes for AJAX/WebSockets
- Ideal for server-driven apps without writing JS
- Rose from #2 in 2023 to #1 in 2024

React (+14.2k):

- React 19 launched with Server Components & Functions
- Native Web Component (Custom Elements) support
- Continues evolution into a framework specification

Svelte & Vue:

- Svelte 5 introduces 'runes' for reactive state
- Vue 3.5 reworks reactivity (alien-signals)

React Ecosystem: shadcn/ui, Excalidraw, and Payload Dominate

- Top 5 React Ecosystem Projects (2024 Stars Added):
 - 1. shadcn/ui (+38.0k) - Accessible, customizable copy-paste components
 - 2. Excalidraw (+27.0k) - Virtual whiteboard for hand-drawn diagrams
 - 3. Payload (+14.4k) - Open-source fullstack Next.js framework
 - 4. Magic UI (+13.2k) - UI library extending shadcn ecosystem
 - 5. Next.js (+12.1k) - The leading React framework
- Ecosystem Shift: React as a Framework Specification
 - • With Server Components and Server Functions in React 19, React has moved from a standalone library to a specification.
 - • Frameworks like Next.js and Remix now interpret React's primitives to provide full-stack architecture.

Vue Ecosystem Flourishes: Nuxt, PrimeVue, and Slidev Lead Growth

- Top 5 Vue Ecosystem Projects (2024 Stars Added):
 - 1. Nuxt (+6.2k) - The leading Vue meta-framework
 - 2. PrimeVue (+5.4k) - Comprehensive Vue UI component library
 - 3. Slidev (+4.7k) - Presentation slides for developers
 - 4. shadcn-vue (+4.1k) - Vue port of the shadcn/ui component system
 - 5. VitePress (+3.7k) - Vue-powered static site generator
- Ecosystem Evolution: Reactivity & UI Growth
 - • Vue 3.5 features a major reactivity system rework.
 - • The lighter 'alien-signals' approach has already landed in the main branch.
 - • The surge of UI libraries (PrimeVue, shadcn-vue) highlights a

AI Tools, Desktop Apps, and Browser-Based Innovation Shape 2024

- Cross-Cutting Industry Themes:
- AI-Powered Automation & Tooling:
 - • n8n (+17.0k): Fair-code workflow automation with native AI capabilities.
 - • Flowise (+14.5k): Drag & drop UI for building custom LLM flows.
- Desktop Apps via Web Technologies:
 - • Tauri (+15.9k): Accelerating the push for lighter, performant desktop and mobile apps built with web frontends.
- Browser Capabilities & Wasm Innovation:
 - • PGLite: Running Postgres directly in the browser via WebAssembly.
 - • WebVM: A complete virtual machine running entirely in the browser.
- Backend-as-a-Service (BaaS):

Key Takeaways: What 2024 Tells Us About JavaScript's Future

- Actionable Insights for 2025:
- 1. Component Ownership Wins Over Imports:
 - • The shadcn/ui copy-paste model proved its staying power, maximizing developer customization.
- 2. HTML-First Approaches Gain Serious Traction:
 - • htmx overtaking React validates server-driven, low-JavaScript architectures for appropriate use cases.
- 3. React is Becoming a Framework Specification:
 - • React 19's Server Components shift focus from purely client-side libraries to full-stack framework primitives.
- 4. AI Integration is Now Table Stakes:
 - • 4 of the top 10 projects have significant AI capabilities, indicating AI is moving from novelty to core workflow.
- 5. Vue's Ecosystem Shows Strong Maturity:
 - • The wave of high-quality UI libraries and the 3.5 reactivity